

Miners Face Cats—

Alburtis Is Lost By UTEP

Senior first baseman Barry Alburtis may be lost for the season due to a shoulder injury, according to U.T.-El Paso coach Andy Cohen.

Alburtis, who has already missed half of the season because of injury problems, was hitting .297 with four home runs before he reinjured a nerve in his shoulder Friday against Arizona State.

"I don't know whether he will be able to play any of the rest of the season," Cohen said. "It doesn't look good. He is in Lubbock trying to get some special treatment."

COHEN SAID that Alburtis would definitely miss the series against the University of Arizona which starts tomorrow at 2 p.m. with a single game at Dudley Field. The two teams meet in a doubleheader Saturday at 1 p.m.

"I am also concerned about Terry Baker," Cohen added. "He still has not been able to throw well because of an injury." Baker, also a senior, has been hitting .244 and has been in and out of the lineup all year.

Cohen did have some good news on the subject of injuries.

"RAY GREGGERSON'S foot is coming around well and it looks like we can use him against Arizona if we need him." Greggerson injured his foot last week in Phoenix when he stepped on a water sprinkler at the team's hotel.

Cohen planned to start either Greggerson or sophomore sensation Bob Knox (3-0) tomorrow. Knox has not allowed an earned run this year in 30 2-3 innings on the mound and is leading the nation in earned run average.

After a three game loss to Arizona State, including a 25-3 setback, can the Miners come back?

"A GOOD BALL club can come back," Cohen observed, "and I think that we have a good ball club. We felt bad about losing all three, but we knew that we faced a good team in ASU."

The Miners are led at bat by Mark Miller (.305), Herb von Hagen (.283), Glen Villarreal (.276) and Eloy Alvarado (.272).

U.T.-El Paso's season record is 7-14 and is 2-4 in WAC play. Arizona has compiled a 26-14 season mark and is 3-3 in the WAC.